

# Simran Singh

PhD Candidate in Political Science

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## Education

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| <b>Columbia University</b> , New York (US)                                                                                           | 2022 – Present |
| PhD Student, Political Science (International Relations, IPE)                                                                        |                |
| <b>Swarthmore College</b> , Swarthmore, PA (US)                                                                                      | 2015 – 2019    |
| B.A. in Honors Political Science and Economics                                                                                       |                |
| Recipient of McCabe Scholarship, full tuition scholarship in recognition of academic achievement, leadership, and community service. |                |

## Working Papers

### **Greener Pastures? A Labor Market Theory of Climate Governance** *With Calvin Thrall & Noah Zucker*

**Abstract:** Climate governance requires access to climate experts: individuals with specialized knowledge of decarbonization and climate science. Here we model climate governance as the function of a competition between the state and private sector for a scarce pool of climate experts. Governments seek experts to develop and implement climate policies. Firms seek experts to affect policy choice, skirt enforcement, and measure climate risks to commercial interests. As firm interest in climate grows, the government's ability to attract experts declines, making it more reliant on the private sector for climate governance. To support this argument, we measure private sector demand for experts with unique data on U.S. job postings, paired with administrative data on government bureaucrats and procurement. Our findings offer a novel labor-based account of climate politics, contributing to the study of labor markets in political science, the sources of bureaucratic expertise, and the net effects of corporate social responsibility.

### **Private pocketbooks for public goods: Policy delegation through mandated CSR**

**Abstract:** Do firms act as complements or substitutes for the state's social development efforts? In this project, I leverage data on firms' mandated CSR spending in India from 2016-2023, and test if foreign multinationals and domestic Indian firms make efforts to advance government development priorities through their CSR expenditures. I examine the extent to which firms align their CSR spending patterns with state governments, with the Indian central government, and with their home country governments to examine the extent to which firms may be acting as agents of the state, on behalf of both their home and host countries. I find that mandated firm CSR can support the state in its public good provision efforts, but that firms rise to the occasion differentially based on their respective potential reputational, instrumental, and compliance-related gains. My project surfaces a channel through which developing states can expand their policy toolkit to achieve social outcomes that the state may be unable to achieve on its own, but highlights the principal-agent challenge that may arise when delegating social policy implementation to private non-state actors.

### **Hollowing the Leader: A Theory of Social Policy Delegation from States to Firms**

**Abstract:** How do governments circumvent political constraints on policy implementation, such as potential voter backlash or regime turnover-induced policy uncertainty? In my dissertation project, I argue that foreign governments in states open to foreign direct investment (FDI) have access to an important channel through which they can pursue certain types of policies with less visible involvement: the activities of multinational corporations. In particular, I investigate the idea that governments can both condition the entry of multinationals and/or threaten to alter the regulatory landscape once

foreign firms have established their presence in a way that ties firms' hands. I develop a theoretical framework analyzing a state's decision to delegate policy implementation to firms, and apply this to two substantive areas in the Indian context: the government's policy priority of increasing female labor force participation, and the government's decarbonization agenda.

## Journal Publications

Chatjuthamard, P., **Simran Singh**, P. Jiraporn, & Sang Mook Lee. (2024). "Climate Change Exposure, Shareholder Wealth, and the Adoption of the Paris Agreement: A Text-based Approach." *International Review of Financial Analysis*. 94.

C Jiraporn, P. Seksak Jumreornvong, N. Jiraporn, & **Simran Singh**. (2015). "How do independent directors view powerful CEOs? Evidence from a quasi-natural experiment." *Finance Research Letters*. 16.

## Other Publications

Baraldi, Derek, Sayli Chitre, John Colas, Manuela Fulga, Ilya Khaykin & **Simran Singh**. (2021). "Financing the Transition to a Net-Zero Future." *World Economic Forum*.

## Teaching Experience

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|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|
| Teaching Assistant, <b>Rise of the Modern World Economy</b> , Professor Jeffrey Frieden             | Fall 2025   |
| Teaching Assistant, <b>Business and Politics</b> , Professor Calvin Thrall                          | Spring 2025 |
| Teaching Assistant, <b>Politics of International Economic Relations</b> , Professor Jeffrey Frieden | Fall 2024   |
| Teaching Assistant, <b>Introduction to International Relations</b> , Professor Jayme Schlesinger    | Spring 2024 |
| Co-Instructor, <b>Inside the Situation Room</b> , Hillary Clinton and Dean Keren Yarhi-Milo         | Fall 2023   |

## Professional Research Experience

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| Research Assistant, Professor Nikhar Gaikwad, Columbia University   | 2022 – Current |
| Research Assistant, Professor Allison Carnegie, Columbia University | 2022 – 2023    |
| Research Assistant, Brookings Institute, Economic Studies           | Summer 2016    |
| Research Assistant, Professor Ayse Kaya, Swarthmore College         | 2014 – 2015    |

## Other Professional Experience

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| Senior Consultant, Finance, Risk and Public Policy Practice, Oliver Wyman | 2019 – 2022 |
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## Service

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| Student Coordinator, <b>Columbia University International Politics Seminar</b>                  | Fall 2023 – Spring 2025 |
| Founding Member, <b>Columbia University Women in Political Science Student Group</b>            | Spring 2025             |
| Student Coordinator, <b>Columbia University International Economics and Geopolitics Seminar</b> | Spring 2025             |
| Member, Swarthmore Board of Managers' Social Responsibility Committee                           | 2017 – 2019             |
| Democracy Fellow, Campus Voter Project, Swarthmore College                                      | 2018 – 2019             |

## **Skills**

**Languages:** English (native), Punjabi (native), Hindi (native), French (intermediate)

**Software:** R, Stata, LaTeX